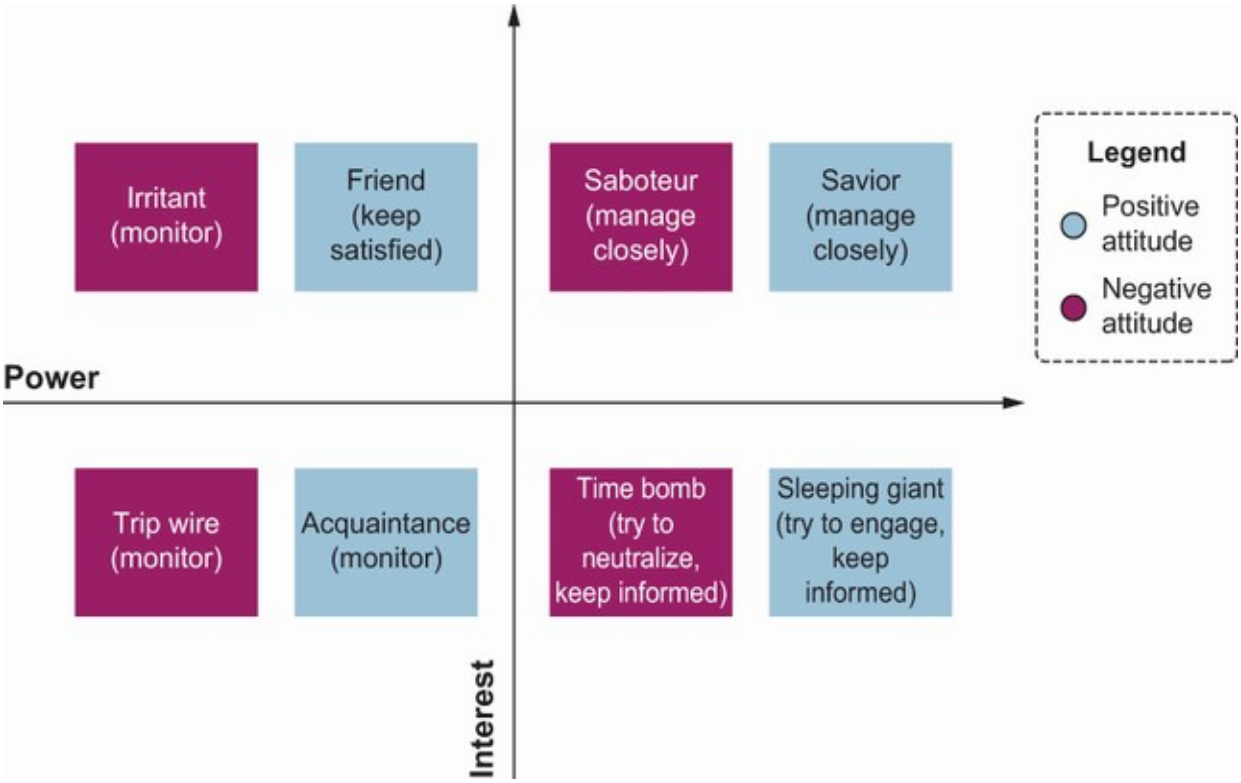


Figure 3.4 Stakeholder type and advised interaction based on position in the matrix

The top-right quadrant is your primary focus. Your *saviors* should be well informed about your progress and, if possible, involved in your activities (e.g., as members of the governance body, described in section 3.2.4). Dealing with *saboteurs* is an art in its own right. The best way to neutralize them is to find a way to understand the threats they perceive and either explain why the reality differs from their perception or, if the danger is real, try to identify a way to create benefits outweighing the losses. The same transparent and proactive attitude may allow you to neutralize *time bombs* (lower right) before their involvement results in unexpected distractions.

On the opposite spectrum, *trip wires* and, surprisingly, *acquaintances* should be intentionally avoided to avert losing energy on managing their involvement. Monitoring that their position on the map hasn't changed should suffice. This is also true for *irritants.*

Your *friends* and *sleeping giants* may become your assets if appropriately engaged. Securing their involvement will strengthen your project.